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FEATURES

Safeguarding dynamic configuration changes at scale

Cosmo W. Q · Airbnb Engineering

How Airbnb ships dynamic config changes safely and reliably.

By Cosmo Qiu , Bo Teng , Siyuan Zhou , Ankur Soni , Willis Harvey

Dynamic configuration is a core infrastructure capability in modern systems. It allows developers to change runtime behavior without restarting or redeploying services, even as the number of services and requests grows. In practice, that might mean rolling out a new address form for a region launch, tightening an authorization rule, or adjusting timeouts when a dependency is slow.

Like any powerful tool, dynamic configuration is a double-edged sword. While it enables fast iteration and rapid incident response, a bad change can cause regressions or even outages. This is a common challenge across the industry: balancing developer flexibility with system reliability.

In this post, we will outline the expectations of a modern dynamic configuration platform, then walk through the high-level architecture of Airbnb's dynamic config platform and how its core components work together to enable safe, flexible config changes.

Modern config platform essentials

As Airbnb's business grows, our expectations for the dynamic config platform have evolved over time through our own learnings as well as industry best practices. These shape our view of what a good dynamic config platform should provide, including:

A coherent experience for config management : The platform provides a streamlined, end-to-end experience for defining, reviewing, testing, and rolling out config changes. It covers the most common needs out of the box with rich built-in features, while still offering escape hatches for edge cases.

Strong reliability, availability and safety guarantees : All config changes are validated, reviewed, and rolled out progressively, with clear ownership and well-defined access control. Treating config as code is a key focus: config changes are versioned, reviewed, and auditable like service code, but remain dynamic at runtime. The platform itself must be highly available so that services can reliably fetch and apply configs. Changes should be observable, with support for fast rollbacks when needed.

Safe testing in isolated environments : Developers can validate config changes in isolated local or canary environments before they reach production.

Flexible multi-tenant support : In a multi-tenant platform, different tenants have different risk profiles. The platform should allow config owners to customize how their con-

figs behave per tenant, including deployment triggers, guardrails, and rollout strategy (for example, AWS zone or Kubernetes pod percentage-based rollouts).

Fast and controlled incident response : During an incident, responders can ship emergency configs as needed with clear auditability. The platform also provides observability for config changes, so incident responders can tell what changed, who was affected, when the change was made, and who made the change. This enables them to effectively identify the culprit and take action.

High-level architecture

At Airbnb, Sitar is the internal name for our dynamic config platform. It provides a common way for teams to manage runtime behavior safely. At a high level, Sitar has four main parts: a developer-facing layer, a control plane, a data plane, and the clients and agents that run alongside application code.

The developer-facing layer is where config changes are created and reviewed. By default, configs are managed through a Git-based workflow, while a few exceptions are managed in the web interface (sitar-portal), which is also used for admin operations such as emergency deployments.

The control plane is responsible for orchestrating config changes. It enforces schema validation, ownership, and access control, and decides how each change should be rolled out: for example, which environments or AWS zone to target, what percentage of Kubernetes pods to start with, and how to progress the rollout over time. The control plane also specifies how to roll back the changes when needed, and supports routing in-flight configs to specific environments or slices of subscribers for fast testing.

The data plane provides scalable storage and efficient distribution of configs. It acts as the source of truth for config values and versions, and propagates updates to services reliably, consistently, and quickly.

On the product services side, an agent sidecar running alongside each service fetches the subscribed configs from the data plane and maintains a local cache. Client libraries inside the service then read from this cache and expose configs to application logic with fast, in-process access and optional fallbacks.

Putting these together, a typical change starts from a Git flow, proceeds through control-plane validation and rollout decisions, into the data plane for distribution, and finally to agents and client libraries that apply the config updates to application logic.

The control plane also specifies how to roll back the changes when needed, and supports routing in-flight configs to specific environments or slices of subscribers for fast testing

The Mac Pro died so Apple silicon could live

Macworld

The Mac Pro, one of Apple's most iconic computers, seemed to have its days numbered. Earlier this month, the company had already dropped another hint with the discontinuation of the Pro Display XDR, which was replaced by the new Studio Display XDR. But the news is now official.

On Thursday, Apple officially confirmed to Macworld that the Mac Pro has been discontinued. The company has also removed the product from its online store, putting an end to the last remaining desktop Mac in Apple's lineup that still carried the "Pro" name in its most traditional sense.

While the move may seem abrupt, especially with Apple's 50th anniversary just days away, the reality is that the Mac Pro's fate had been sealed for quite some time.

A long goodbye for Apple's most ambitious Mac

The Mac Pro has always represented Apple's most powerful and flexible computer. From the aluminum towers of the 2000s to the controversial cylindrical design in 2013 and the return to modularity in 2019, the Mac Pro was built for professionals who needed uncompromising performance. Read our Towers of Power (now) complete history of Apple's sometimes inglorious forays into the professional workstation market.

When Apple reintroduced the Mac Pro in 2019 alongside the Pro Display XDR, it was a statement. After years of neglecting high-end users, the company was ready to win them back with a truly modular system designed for demanding workflows like film production, 3D rendering, and audio engineering.

But that strategy was short-lived.

The Mac Studio changed everything

Just a year after introducing the redesigned Mac Pro, Apple revealed its plans to shift from Intel processors to its own Apple Silicon chips. In November 2020, the company announced the first Macs with the M1 chip.

The M1 was never a chip designed for high-end users, but the leap in performance was so significant that many professionals realized they could do photo and video editing, coding, and other demanding tasks on these Macs without needing a super expensive computer.

Apple Silicon has made the Mac Studio as powerful as the Mac Pro.

But it was in 2022 when the Mac Pro's fate seemed to be in jeopardy. The arrival of the Mac Studio reshaped Apple's professional desktop strategy. While the Mac Pro was still based on an old Intel processor, the first Mac Studio had an M1 Ultra chip that outperformed Apple's super-expensive desktop tower.

Apple's silicon roadmap has made the Mac Studio powerful enough to replace the Mac Pro for most people. For less than half the price and a fraction of the footprint, customers could finally buy a Mac that was even faster than the Mac Pro.

Eventually, Apple put its own chip inside the Mac Pro, but Apple silicon didn't have the same impact. It ran the same M2 Ultra chip as the Mac Studio, and the main difference between the Mac Pro and the Mac Studio was the ability to add internal storage and PCIe expansion cards. And it still cost thousands more than the Mac Studio.

The dreams of a workstation chip or standalone graphics didn't come to pass. For the vast majority of users, that wasn't enough to justify the higher price tag.

The signs were always there

While the Mac Pro hasn't seen an update since 2023, Apple continued to refresh the rest of the desktop Mac lineup with newer and more efficient chips.

By the time Apple refreshed the Mac Studio with M3 Ultra and M4 Max, it became obvious that the company no longer saw a future for the Mac Pro. The Mac Studio powered by the M3 Ultra chip outperformed the Apple Silicon Mac Pro in pretty much every benchmark, but at a fraction of the price.

The Mac Pro has been on the way out of Apple's lineup for a while.

Apple never explicitly said the Mac Pro was going away, but the signs kept piling up. The discontinuation of the Pro Display XDR, the absence of the Mac Pro in marketing materials, and the increasing focus on the Studio lineup all pointed in the same direction.

Even rumors suggested that Apple had deprioritized the Mac Pro internally, with plans for future updates reportedly scrapped. Now, with the product officially discontinued, those signals make perfect sense in hindsight. It existed in the Mac lineup, but Apple couldn't have sold more than a handful of them, if that.

The discontinuation marks the end of an era for the Mac Pro. For decades, it stood as the ultimate expression of Apple's desktop ambitions: powerful, modular, and expensive. But Apple in 2026 is a very different company from the one that introduced the Mac Pro in 2006.

Today, efficiency and integration matter more than modularity. Apple Silicon has enabled the company to deliver workstation-level performance in smaller, quieter, and more affordable machines. It's no wonder Apple just launched its most affordable laptop, the MacBook Neo, for just \$599.

For professionals, the Mac Studio is now the logical choice. And for Apple, simplifying the lineup likely makes more sense than maintaining a niche product with limited ap-

Kalshi moves to tighten rules, says politicians and athletes will be barred from trading on related markets

Suswati Basu · ReadWrite

Kalshi is tightening who can trade on its prediction markets, drawing clearer limits around insider activity as the platform grows into more sensitive areas.

In a blog post published Monday (March 23), the company said it is “launching new technological guardrails that preemptively block politicians, athletes, and other relevant people from trading in certain politics and sports markets.”

The changes target political candidates and people involved in college and professional sports. Kalshi said it has “launched tools that will aim to preemptively block political candidates if they try to trade on their own campaigns.”

The company added that it already blocks elected officials such as members of Congress, and said the new system is designed to extend those checks to candidates as well.

Today, we’re announcing an expansion of our efforts to prevent insider trading on Kalshi – new guardrails and policies to preemptively block politicians and athletes from trading in certain politics and sports markets.

These efforts, which have been in the works for months,...

— robertjdenault (@robertjdenault) March 23, 2026

Kalshi also described a new sports policy. It said “individuals involved in college and professional sports (including athletes, personnel, and referees) will be preemptively blocked from trading markets associated with sports in affiliated leagues they are involved in.” According to the post, the trades were already banned under existing rules, but enforcement previously came after trades were placed.

The company said the updated system follows “months of collecting and developing screening lists for both collegiate and professional sports leagues.” Working with integrity-monitoring firm IC360, Kalshi said “known athletes, officials, and employees will be blocked from trading in associated markets.”

New rules from Kalshi target political and sports contracts

Kalshi described the update as part of a wider compliance push tied to growing regulatory attention. The company said the effort was developed over months and “proactively address[es] the CFTC’s guidance and Congressional bill proposals to prevent insider trading. ”

Kalshi said it “recently brought an enforcement action against a candidate who traded on his own election in violation of Kalshi’s exchange rules.” It added: “Today’s update means that our systems will now aim to preemptively block these kinds of trades.”

Alongside trade restrictions, the company is adding reporting tools. It said it is introducing “a whistleblower functionality straight in our market page,” so users can flag suspicious activity using public trading data.

Rival platform Polymarket has tightened its own rules after disputes tied to political bets and early cashouts, including a high-profile market connected to Venezuela’s elections where questions about informational advantages surfaced.

Lawmakers are also weighing new limits. A proposal known as the “Bets Off Act ” would restrict certain government-related prediction markets.

Kalshi’s leadership has argued that clearer restrictions are necessary if the category is to gain regulatory acceptance. For now, the company is attempting to put more weight on prevention.

“Ensuring market integrity is not just a goal – it is a cornerstone of our business model,” the company wrote.

Featured image: Kalshi / Grok

The post Kalshi moves to tighten rules, says politicians and athletes will be barred from trading on related markets appeared first on ReadWrite .

iOS compatibility: What iOS version can your iPhone run – and is it still secure?

Macworld

Unsure which version of iOS your iPhone can run? Here's a quick guide so you can find out if your iPhone is compatible with the most recent iterations of the iPhone operating system, and, if it isn't, which version you can install on your iPhone.

iPhone iOS Compatibility: At a Glance

Find your iPhone in our iPhone iOS support table and see which version of iOS you can run.

Which iPhone do you have? Which version of iOS can you run? iPhone 17e 2026 iOS 26 iPhone 17 Pro (Max) 2025 iOS 26 iPhone Air 2025 iOS 26 iPhone 17 2025 iOS 26 iPhone 16e 2025 iOS 26 iPhone 16 Pro (Max) 2024 iOS 26 iPhone 16 (Plus) 2024 iOS 26 iPhone 15 Pro (Max) 2023 iOS 26 iPhone 15 (Plus) 2023 iOS 26 iPhone 14 Pro (Max) 2022 iOS 26 iPhone 14 (Plus) 2022 iOS 26 iPhone SE (3rd gen) 2022 iOS 26 iPhone 13 Pro (Max) 2021 iOS 26 iPhone 13 (mini) 2021 iOS 26 iPhone 12 Pro (Max) 2020 iOS 26 iPhone 12 (mini) 2020 iOS 26 iPhone SE (2nd gen) 2020 iOS 26 iPhone 11 Pro (Max) 2019 iOS 26 iPhone 11 2019 iOS 26 iPhone XR 2018 iOS 18 iPhone XS (Max) 2018 iOS 18 iPhone X 2017 iOS 16 iPhone 8 (Plus) 2017 iOS 16 iPhone 7 (Plus) 2016 iOS 15 iPhone SE (1st gen) 2016 iOS 15 iPhone 6s (Plus) 2015 iOS 15

If your iPhone runs iOS 15 or newer, it is still receiving security updates and is safe to use

The latest version of the iPhone operating system is iOS 26 , which will continue to receive new features until the next major release, iOS 27 , launches in the fall of 2026.

Even if your iPhone can't run the latest version of iOS, it is safe to use as long as it continues to receive security updates. Apple often releases security updates for older iOS versions to patch flaws that are being exploited.

For example, in March 2026 the “ DarkSword ” hacking toolkit was identified as targeting iPhones running older versions of iOS 18. The security holes used by the DarkSword malware were addressed in the iOS 18.7.6 update.

If you use an iPhone running a version of iOS that Apple doesn't support with security updates, you are at risk of exploitation attacks targeting flaws in older software versions.

Some updates may also be necessary to maintain certificates needed for essential services like iMessage, FaceTime, and device activation, so if you aren't running a supported version of iOS you may find these features stop working.

The good news is that all of the iPhone models listed in the table above are currently supported by Apple, although the level of support varies.

Apple continues to provide security updates for the following older versions of iOS:

iOS 15 and iOS 16 received updates to address security vulnerabilities in March 2026

iOS 18 received a critical security update in March 2026

Apple doesn't need to update iOS 17 , because every iPhone that runs it can upgrade to a newer version.

This means that, for now at least, the following older iPhones are still receiving security updates:

iPhone X

iPhone 8

iPhone 7

iPhone SE (1st generation)

iPhone 6s – the oldest supported iPhone

We don't know how much longer Apple will continue to support iOS 15 and iOS 16 — and these iPhones. As we explain in How long Apple supports iPhones for , the company has already classified the iPhone SE (1st generation) as obsolete, while the iPhone 6s, iPhone 7, iPhone 8 and iPhone X are on Apple's vintage list. These classifications mean it may no longer be possible to get these devices repaired through Apple.

Should I upgrade my iPhone?

IDG

If your iPhone can't run the newest version of iOS, that doesn't necessarily mean you need to upgrade. While you won't get the latest features, Apple continues to issue software updates to address security vulnerabilities in recent versions of iOS. Even with the arrival of iOS 26, Apple has continued to support iOS 18, iOS 16 and iOS 15 with security updates – and, with those versions of iOS, 2015's iPhone 6s through to 2018's iPhone XR and iPhone XS.

However, if you're using an older iPhone, security is the key concern. Apple is still providing security patches for older devices via iOS 15 and iOS 16, but this support is unlikely to last much longer.

By contrast, iOS 18 support is expected to continue for several more years, extending the usable life of the iPhone XS and XR.

Once your device can no longer run a supported version of iOS, it's time to seriously consider upgrading. We explain how long Apple supports the iPhone for in a separate article, and you can see full iOS compatibility in the chart above.

As a general rule, any iPhone that can't run iOS 26 is nearing the end of its practical lifespan.

Bluesky's Newest Product: an AI Tool That Gives You Custom Feeds

EditorDavid · Slashdot

“What happens when you can describe the social experience you want and have it built for you...?” asks Bluesky? “We’ve just started experimenting, but we’re sharing it now because we want you to build alongside us.”

Called “Attie” — because it’s built with Bluesky’s decentralized publishing framework, AT Protocol (which is open source) — the new assistant turns natural language prompts into social feeds, without users having to know how to code. (It’s part of Bluesky’s mission to “develop and drive large-scale adoption of technologies for open and decentralized public conversation.”)

Engadget reports:

On the Attie website, examples include prompts like, “Show me electronic music and experimental sound from people in my network” or “Builders working on agent infrastructure and open protocol design.”

“It feels more like having a conversation than configuring software,” [writes Bluesky’s former CEO/current chief innovation officer, Jay Graber, in a blog post]. “You describe the sort of posts you want to see, and the coding agent builds the feed you described.” Graber added that Attie is a separate app from Bluesky and users don’t have to use the new AI assistant if they don’t want to. However, since Attie and Bluesky were built on the same framework, it could mean there will be some cross-app implementation between the two or any other app built on the AT Protocol.

“Attie is open for beta signups today, and we’ll be sharing what we learn along the way,” Graber writes in the blog post. “To learn more about Attie, visit: Attie. AI. Come help us find out what this can be.” The blog post warns that “Right now, AI is undermining human agency at the same time it’s enhancing it,” since “The proliferation of low-quality AI-generated content is making public social networks noisier and less trustworthy...” And in a world where “signal is getting harder to find... The major platforms aren’t trying to fix this problem.”

They’re using AI to increase the time users spend on-platform, to harvest training data, and to shape what users see and believe through systems they can’t inspect and didn’t choose. We think AI should serve people, not platforms...

An open protocol puts this power directly in users’ hands. You can use it to build your own feeds, create software that works the way you want it to, and find signal in the noise. We built the AT Protocol so anyone could build any app they imagine on top of it, but until recently “anyone” really meant “anyone who can code.” Agentic coding tools change that. For the first time, an open protocol can be genuinely open to everyone...

The Atmosphere [Bluesky’s interoperable ecosystem] is an open data layer with a clearly defined schema for applica-

tions, which makes it uniquely well-suited for coding agents to build on... Bluesky will continue to evolve as a social app millions of people rely on. Attie will be where we experiment with agentic social.

AI is an accelerant on whatever it’s applied to. I want it to accelerate decentralizing social and putting power back in users’ hands. But I don’t think the most interesting things built on AT Protocol will come from us. They’re going to come from everyone who picks up these tools and starts building.

Read more of this story at Slashdot.

2026.12: Please Listen to My Podcast

Ben Thompson · *Stratechery*

Welcome back to This Week in Stratechery!

As a reminder, each week, every Friday, we're sending out this overview of content in the Stratechery bundle; highlighted links are free for everyone . Additionally, you have complete control over what we send to you. If you don't want to receive This Week in Stratechery emails (there is no podcast), please uncheck the box in your delivery settings .

On that note, here were a few of our favorites this week.

Everything I Didn't Write . This was one of those weeks where far more happened than I could write about — and that's partly my fault for taking a stand on bubbles ! To that end, I highly suggest this week's episode of Sharp Tech , where we cover:

OpenAI's pivot to enterprise, and why AI might look like the PC in the 1980s

Why I think that agents are not only real, but also the reason we are not in a bubble

OpenClaw as evidence that my thesis that OpenAI and Anthropic are sustainably differentiated through their integration of harness and model is wrong

Nvidia's inference pivot, and why Nvidia is particularly concerned about a world dominated by OpenAI and Anthropic (and why Microsoft might be in trouble)

And, for good measure, why I don't mind Wisconsin winters

I think that each of these points could be another Update, but also, I'm taking a few days off for vacation, so I hope you'll listen to this episode in particular. — Ben Thompson

What Jensen Huang Has In Common with Steve Jobs. I really enjoyed this week's Dithering covering Nvidia's announcements at GTC Monday , including a near-perfect inversion of what Jensen Huang was telling the world about Nvidia's approach to inference workloads just one year ago. In their trademark 15-minute format, Ben explains how and why Nvidia's inference messaging is now different (see also : this week's Stratechery Interview), while Gruber draws on decades of Apple experience to note the similarities between Huang and Steve Jobs. It's a great listen that renders legible an easily missed strategic inflection point at the most valuable company in the world . — Andrew Sharp

Trump's Trip to Beijing, Delayed Indefinitely. As the war in Iran continues, this week's Sharp China covered the news that President Trump will delay a trip to Beijing that had been scheduled to begin March 31st . Come to hear why both sides are likely relieved by the delay, and stay to hear about a softened Taiwan threat assessments from the U. S. intelligence community and a succession of PLA military

scientists who are being purged for reasons that aren't entirely clear. — AS

Stratechery Articles and Updates

Agents Over Bubbles — Agents are fundamentally changing the shape of demand for compute, both in terms of how they work and in terms of who will use them. They're so compelling that I no longer believe we're in a bubble.

An Interview with Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang About Accelerated Computing — An interview with Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang about his GTC 2026 keynote, navigating China and DC, and remembering Nvidia's true nature.

Jensen Huang and Andy Grove, Groq LPUs and Vera CPUs, Hotel California — GTC 2026 marked an important inflection point for Nvidia, as the company is selling multiple architectures, instead of focusing on just one GPU. The motivation is serve all needs and keep all customers.

What the NBA Could Be Getting from College Basketball — College basketball is fantastic, and the NBA should take advantage of its success by raising the age limit for the NBA Draft.

Dithering with Ben Thompson and Daring Fireball's John Gruber

LLM Paradigm Changes

Jensen Huang's Jobsian Keynote

Asianometry with Jon Yu

From Fiber to AI: A Laser Giant's Rebirth

Mexico City's Sinking Lands

Sharp China with Andrew Sharp and Sinocism's Bill Bishop

The War in Iran and the Visit to Beijing; New DNI Assessments on Taiwan; Military Scientists Disappearing From Public View

Greatest of All Talk with Andrew Sharp and Ben Golliver

How to Miss a Free Throw, The Biggest Top 100 Disappointments, Expansion is Afoot (Again)

How NOT to Miss a Free Throw, Generic Houston Rockets Slander, The Top 100 Pleasant Surprises

Sharp Tech with Andrew Sharp and Ben Thompson

OpenAI's Enterprise Pivot, The Rise of Agents and Bubble Counterpoints, Nvidia Changes Its Inference Story

This week's Sharp Tech video is on Questions about Anthropic vs. the U. S. Government.

— *Andrew Sharp Trump's Trip to Beijing, Delayed Indefinitely.*

Ben Thompson

Prediction markets forum set to debut at SBC Summit Americas

Paul McNally · ReadWrite

Prediction markets will take center stage at this summer's SBC Summit Americas, as the fast-growing industry continues to spark debate across the U. S. gambling and financial industries.

The Prediction Markets Forum is scheduled for June 11 and will run as part of the conference's Breakout Stage lineup. The forum will bring together sportsbook executives, legal experts, analysts, and academics to unpack how these markets are evolving and what their rise could mean for traditional sports betting.

Patrick Everson, a longtime sports betting analyst and contributor to FOX Sports, will chair the four-session program. The agenda centers on discussions of how sportsbooks are experimenting with event contracts, as well as the mounting regulatory and integrity concerns that have followed the sector's rapid expansion.

Prediction markets surge into public view

Prediction markets entered the mainstream spotlight during the 2024 U. S. presidential election cycle, when trading on political event contracts took off in popularity. The surge in activity during that period drew attention from major betting operators and regulators alike, pushing the products into broader public and political conversations.

Since then, operators such as DraftKings, FanDuel, and Fanatics have all explored ways to gain a foothold in the space. At the same time, dedicated platforms like Kalshi and Polymarket have increased their visibility through athlete endorsements and partnerships with sports leagues. Their growth has also attracted legal scrutiny, including a recent Nevada court decision that blocked certain Kalshi event contracts, and ongoing questions about whether these products should be treated as financial instruments or gambling offerings.

SBC CEO and Founder Rasmus Sojmark said the uncertainty is becoming a defining issue for the U. S. market.

"Prediction markets will define the American market in 2026. But navigating the grey area between financial trading and traditional betting is creating real uncertainty for the sector," said Sojmark. "This forum will bring together the people who are shaping this space to help the industry understand what comes next."

Four sessions set to explore key industry questions

The opening session, "Prediction Markets 101," is designed as a historical and technical primer. Dan Zucker, president of Zucker Media Group, is expected to trace how event contracts evolved from 19th-century hedging tools into what many now see as a fast-emerging, potentially billion-dollar segment of the broader wagering ecosystem.

One session will focus on how traditional sportsbooks are testing strategies to step into this new territory. Scheduled speakers include Dr. Laila Mintas of Dr. Mintas Consulting, Sporttrade COO David Huffman, and analyst Dustin Gouker, who are set to discuss whether partnerships with state-affiliated entities or exchanges could help sportsbooks navigate complex compliance requirements.

Another panel will examine the regulatory landscape. Attorney Dan Wallach will outline the current legal landscape, including recent enforcement actions by state regulators and evolving guidance from the Commodity Futures Trading Commission. A recent CFTC advisory signaled a more pragmatic approach to sports-related prediction markets, while cooperation between the CFTC and SEC on crypto-linked event contracts has added another layer of oversight.

The final session, "What's the Future of Futures?," will focus on long-term implications. Academic and industry speakers, including Ilya Beylin of Seton Hall University School of Law and economist Robin D. Hanson of George Mason University, are expected to debate how continued litigation and the possibility of U. S. Supreme Court involvement could reshape both the betting and financial trading landscapes.

Prediction markets also featured across the wider summit

Beyond the dedicated forum, prediction markets will also be discussed on the summit's Leaders Stage in a separate panel examining how the products are developing across North America. With regulators, sportsbooks, and financial platforms all testing the boundaries of the model, prediction markets are likely to remain a central topic of discussion throughout the summit.

Featured image: Headway/Unsplash

The post Prediction markets forum set to debut at SBC Summit Americas appeared first on ReadWrite .

How Super Meat Boy 3D captures the series' identity, out March 31

Dominik Pläßmann · PlayStation Blog

When Super Meat Boy first released, it quickly became a landmark for indie games. It wasn't just a great platformer, but a figurehead for indie gaming, defined by lightning-fast gameplay and brutal difficulty.

So, when we began working on Super Meat Boy 3D, our biggest goal was simple: it had to feel like Meat Boy. We worked on the prototype for a few months to test out our main ingredients, and what was firstly more of a feeling we wished to translate, became much more concrete when we started working with Tommy of Team Meat.

Translating such a precise 2D platformer into a fully navigable 3D space meant rethinking many parts of the game while protecting the core identity of the series.

Finding the right camera

One of the main challenges was that Meat Boy moves so quickly that a dynamic camera just couldn't keep up.

We tested three different camera systems during prototyping. While a traditional third-person camera that players could freely control technically worked, it never quite felt right. Eventually we landed on a controlled camera angle that stays consistent relative to the level. It's not completely static but designed to prioritize clarity and readability.

That decision shaped the entire design process. Instead of placing a camera into finished levels, we built levels around the camera angle so players can always clearly see the character's movement and the path ahead, to ensure the gameplay remains readable at a high speed.

Translating 2D precision into 3D

After we tried recreating the feel of the original purely from our experience of playing Super Meat Boy, our collaboration with Tommy Refenes from Team Meat gave us a deeper understanding of exactly how a lot of the original systems worked. In some cases, we even used similar values from the original game, like wall-jump distances or how jumping behaves when touching a wall versus standing on the ground. Having those reference points helped us capture the familiar feel of Meat Boy's movement.

Of course, with the added difficulty of depth perception, the 2D game cannot just be moved into 3D one to one. Players need to feel completely in control of their movement even with an extra dimension.

To help maintain clarity, we introduced several structural decisions, such as eight-directional stick movement to keep movement predictable, 45-degree angles in level design to help players anticipate their trajectory, and visual helpers, like a ground circle indicator and a line connecting the character to the ground to help judge distance.

Even with these systems, movement tuning took a long time. We spent roughly a year refining the feel, and small tweaks continued almost until release, especially given the valuable input we received from players of our demo.

Designing new mechanics

Some mechanics translated easily. The vertical wall slide, for example, already existed in the original game, so we could closely replicate it. Wall running on the other hand had to be designed from scratch. Making it feel smooth requires a lot of value-tweaking and subtle assists so that it feels fast and satisfying rather than too frustrating.

Many of those adjustments are invisible to players, but they help ensure the mechanic feels fair even at high speed.

Balancing freedom and precision

The essential core loop of Super Meat Boy – fail, learn, retry – is only possible to get right by balancing player freedom with systems that help them maintain control, but in 3D, movement can naturally feel slightly floatier because of the added spatial depth.

Movement and level design evolved together throughout development. The layout of each level directly affects how the character feels to control, so we constantly iterated between the two.

In the end, we found that the core ideas of Meat Boy's movement translate surprisingly well into 3D if the focus remains on the fundamentals: jumping, walls, and speed. The key was in the camera angles and the subsequent level design. We usually started by choosing the camera angle first, then building the level to support it. The most important rule was that the character must always remain visible and readable.

Preserving the series' personality

The series is not only known for its tight platformer gameplay, but also its dark humor, exaggerated violence, and chaotic energy.

One classic feature is the blood trail that Meat Boy leaves behind. It doesn't only add the trademark gore-factor, but it also helps players see where they've already been and which routes they've tried.

In 3D, that feature became even more important, but implementing it was technically challenging. Spawning huge numbers of decals wasn't practical, so we developed a vertex painting system that lets blood dynamically stain the environment, letting players paint the entire level red if they try often enough.

The move to 3D also gave us more room for hidden jokes and visual gags. With extra space in the world, we could tuck funny details or secrets into the background, some of which players might never even notice.

This MacBook Air can be your digital buddy for just \$200

Macworld

TL;DR: A refurbished MacBook Air for \$199.97 delivers reliable everyday performance, long battery life, and serious value.

Not every laptop needs to be a powerhouse. Sometimes you just need something that works —reliably, quickly, and without costing a small fortune. That's exactly what this refurbished MacBook Air does.

At just \$199.97 (MSRP \$999), it's positioned less like a primary workstation and more like your go-to digital bestie. Think streaming shows on the couch, answering emails, online shopping, paying bills, or tossing it in your bag for a weekend trip.

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This is the laptop you grab when you want to get things done.

Get a refurbished MacBook Air (2017) for just \$199.97 (MSRP \$999) with free shipping while stock lasts.

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Folk Etymologies

Penny Arcade

As something of a connected phenomenon - my instinct is to say "corollary," but I think that's not correct - as Penny Arcade was unearthed by the wily Zillennial, the many fruits of our enterprise became known. The true facts of the name PAX, for example - a name I came up with in five seconds at Costco because we got a call saying the show thing we were trying to do needed a name. I'm always delighted when someone finds the information I tucked in there. Never you mind that the next question is usually "what's a Penny Arcade" because that's not what this story is about!!!

3-inch display is sharp enough for streaming, and with up to 12 hours of battery life, you're not constantly hunting for an outlet.

Macworld

Is It Time For Open Source to Start Charging For Access?

EditorDavid · Slashdot

“It’s time to charge for access,” argues a new opinion piece at The Register. Begging billion-dollar companies to fund open source projects just isn’t enough, writes long-time tech reporter Steven J. Vaughan-Nichols:

Screw fair. Screw asking for dimes. You can’t live off one-off charity donations... Depending on what people put in a tip jar is no way to fund anything of value... [A]ccording to a 2024 Tidelift maintainer report, 60 percent of open source maintainers are unpaid, and 60 percent have quit or considered quitting, largely due to burnout and lack of compensation. Oh, and of those getting paid, only 26 percent earn more than \$1,000 a year for their work. They’d be better paid asking “Would you like fries with that?” at your local McDonald’s...

Some organizations do support maintainers, for example, there’s HeroDevs and its \$20 million Open Source Sustainability Fund. Its mission is to pay maintainers of critical, often end-of-life open source components so they can keep shipping patches without burning out. Sentry’s Open Source Pledge/Fund has given hundreds of thousands of dollars per year directly to maintainers of the packages Sentry depends on. Sentry is one of the few vendors that systematically maps its dependency tree and then actually cuts checks to the people maintaining that stack, as opposed to just talking about “giving back.”

Sentry is on to something. We have the Linux Foundation to manage commercial open source projects, the Apache Foundation to oversee its various open source programs, the Open Source Initiative (OSI) to coordinate open source licenses, and many more for various specific projects. It’s time we had an organization with the mission of ensuring that the top programmers and maintainers of valuable open source projects get a cut of the tech billionaire pie.

We must realign how businesses work with open source so that payment is no longer an optional charitable gift but a cost of doing business. To do that, we need an organization to create a viable, supportable path from big business to individual programmer. It’s time for someone to step up and make this happen. Businesses, open source software, and maintainers will all be better off for it.

One possible future... Bruce Perens wrote the original Open Source definition in 1997, and now proposes a not-for-profit corporation developing “the Post Open Collection” of software, distributing its licensing fees to developers while providing services like user support, documentation, hardware-based authentication for developers, and even help with government compliance and lobbying.

Read more of this story at Slashdot.

Get the latest Microsoft Office for your Mac for under \$100 – No Subscription

Macworld

TL;DR: Microsoft Office 2024 Home & Business for Mac is available for under \$100 as a one-time purchase, giving you the latest Office apps without paying for Microsoft 365 every year.

Mac users often assume that Microsoft Office means signing up for Microsoft 365 and paying a yearly fee just to use Word, Excel, and PowerPoint. That subscription can run \$70 to \$100 per year, which adds up. Bypass that yearly fee, and instead get Microsoft Office 2024 Home & Business for Mac (or PC) for under \$100. You’ll save money in the long term while still getting the latest version of the apps you use every day.

Office 2024 includes the core apps:

PowerPoint

OneNote

This version also includes performance improvements and newer tools compared to older Office versions. Excel handles larger datasets more smoothly, PowerPoint now supports recording presentations with voice and video, and Word includes AI-assisted writing suggestions and focus mode for distraction-free writing.

The interface has also been updated with Microsoft’s Fluent design system, making the apps feel more modern and consistent across Mac and PC. Real-time collaboration, commenting, and version history also make it easier to work on

shared documents or projects.

For Mac users who want Microsoft Office but don’t want another subscription, a lifetime license is often the cheaper option after just a year or two.

Microsoft Office 2024 Home & Business for Mac is available now for \$99.97 (MSRP \$249.99) as a one-time purchase.

Microsoft Office 2024 Home & Business for Mac or PC Lifetime License See Deal

Want to see more deals? Visit the shop and use code MARCH15 to save an extra 15% sitewide through March 29. Exclusions apply.

StackSocial prices subject to change.

Its mission is to pay maintainers of critical, often end-of-life open source components so they can keep shipping patches without burning out.

EditorDavid

ANALYSIS

Boyd Gaming opens Cadence Crossing Casino in fast-growing Henderson

Paul McNally · ReadWrite

Boyd Gaming has opened Cadence Crossing Casino in Henderson, adding a new neighborhood gaming option in one of the Las Vegas Valley's fastest-growing residential corridors. The opening comes just about one year after the company broke ground on the casino .

The property, located next to the master-planned Cadence community, began welcoming guests this week and represents the company's latest push to deepen its footprint in the local Southern Nevada market.

At roughly 10,000 square feet, Cadence Crossing is designed with local customers in mind rather than tourists. The casino floor is anchored by more than 450 slot machines and video poker terminals, along with electronic table games arranged across an open layout that keeps sightlines clear from the entrance to the back of the room.

We are excited to introduce Cadence Crossing Casino, our newest entertainment experience for southern Nevada locals," said Steve Schutte, Boyd Gaming's executive vice president of operations. "Cadence Crossing is a modern and stylish gaming entertainment experience worthy of the Cadence community."

A 22-seat circular bar sits at the center of the floor, serving as a social hub where guests can watch the action from every angle while ordering from a menu of signature cocktails. Just beyond it, a quieter lounge area with softer lighting and more relaxed seating offers a break from the noise of the machines.

Dining and live music aimed at repeat visits

Boyd has leaned heavily on food and entertainment to position the property as more than a place to gamble. The casino's main restaurant, Tin Lizard Bar & Grill, features a gastropub-style menu, craft beer, and wall-to-wall sports screens. The venue is also scheduled to host live music from Thursday through Sunday, with local performers rotating through the lineup.

For guests who want a quick meal without leaving the gaming floor, a nearby fast-casual option offers grab-and-go options, in another nod to the convenience-focused design aimed at neighborhood customers.

Part of a broader portfolio shift

The opening comes as Boyd continues to reshape its national portfolio while doubling down on markets where it already has a strong customer base. The company recently agreed to sell its Sam's Town Shreveport property in Louisiana to Bally's, a move executives described as part of a broader effort to streamline operations and focus on core regions.

That strategy is especially visible in southern Nevada, where rapid population growth in communities such as Cadence has created demand for smaller, locally oriented gaming venues rather than large Strip-style resorts. This local-first strategy also takes into account a significant decrease in room visits.

Boyd Gaming 2024 to 20025 year-over-year revenue changes:

Gaming: 2.1% increase Food & Beverage: 2.2% increase Room: (6.5)% decline \$BYD officials said they were seeing significant room visit declines in not just their Nevada segments but also other regional properties

— Ryan Butler (@ButlerBets) February 5, 2026

Cadence Crossing reflects that approach. By pairing a compact gaming floor with dining, live music, and a layout designed for convenience, Boyd is betting that proximity and familiarity, rather than spectacle, will keep local customers coming back and strengthen its position in the competitive Las Vegas-area market.

Featured image: Coolcaesar at en.wikipedia, CC BY-SA 3.0 <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0> , via Wikimedia Commons

The post Boyd Gaming opens Cadence Crossing Casino in fast-growing Henderson appeared first on ReadWrite .

Indian Gaming Association backs bipartisan Senate bill targeting sports prediction markets

Suswati Basu · ReadWrite

The Indian Gaming Association (IGA) has stepped into the growing fight over sports-based prediction markets, throwing its support behind a bipartisan Senate bill that would shut them down. The move adds fresh pressure on federal regulators and companies offering the products as scrutiny spreads well beyond the initial rollout phase.

Prediction markets are offering sports bets — just with a different name.

They are being offered in states where sports betting is illegal, like California, while federal regulators are green-lighting them rather than enforcing the law.

My bipartisan legislation with... pic.twitter.com/oNvI2vw9IP

— Adam Schiff (@SenAdamSchiff) March 23, 2026

Lawmakers Adam Schiff and John Curtis introduced the measure, called the “ Prediction Markets Are Gambling Act .” It would stop federally regulated exchanges from listing contracts tied to sports wagering or casino-style activity. The proposal would update the Commodity Exchange Act to block entities overseen by the Commodity Futures Trading Commission from offering those contracts. The Senate Agriculture Committee is expected to take it up.

IGA tribal leaders frame Senate bill as restoring authority against sports prediction markets

Leaders within the association say the legislation is about restoring balance between federal oversight and long-standing state and tribal control of gambling. IGA Chairman David Bean described the bill as a necessary correction to what he views as a regulatory gap that has allowed prediction markets to expand unchecked.

“It will reaffirm existing tribal and state government authority to regulate sports betting, limit online gambling, or in some cases – continue to prohibit all forms of gambling,” Bean told ReadWrite.

IGA statement: The Indian Gaming Association welcomes the introduction of the “Prediction Markets Are Gambling Act” @RWW pic.twitter.com/IBKM0rHYiI

— Suswati Basu (@suswatibasus) March 23, 2026

Bean also took aim at how regulators have handled the issue so far. “The bill will also quiet the chaos and federal overreach that the CFTC is fostering. Other than the growing number of court decisions siding with tribes and states, prediction market platforms have seen no accountability and no oversight, as they disregard clearly established regulations while exposing consumers to unchecked gambling. We look forward to working with leaders in Congress to hold

these platforms accountable to protect consumers, sports integrity, and tribal and state sovereignty.”

That places the IGA squarely in the middle of a widening policy clash. Much of the tension is said to center on the CFTC’s handling of event-based contracts. Rules adopted in 2011 bar registered entities from listing contracts tied to activities like terrorism, war, or gaming that may be unlawful under federal or state law. The IGA argues that enforcement shifted in January 2025, when the agency dropped key court appeals, effectively stepping back from its own restrictions.

The group also criticized CFTC Chairman Michael Selig , saying he has “actively fostered online sports gambling through prediction markets.” It pointed to legal filings opposing state and tribal challenges, along with plans to revisit existing rules.

Meanwhile, interest in the issue is growing on Capitol Hill. Lawmakers in both parties have raised concerns that these platforms resemble gambling but lack standard consumer protections. Separate proposals would also prevent federal officials from participating in prediction markets , citing potential conflicts of interest. Despite coming from very different regulatory environments, Schiff and Curtis appear to have found common ground. California maintains a tightly controlled tribal gaming system and bans sports betting, while Utah prohibits all gambling . Even so, both senators are pushing to reinforce local authority.

Featured image: David Bean via LinkedIn

The post Indian Gaming Association backs bipartisan Senate bill targeting sports prediction markets appeared first on ReadWrite .

Harrison Katz · Airbnb Engineering

By : Harrison Katz

In March 2020, the forecasting models that had served us well in stable times faced a new challenge: predicting outcomes in a world that had suddenly changed.

At Airbnb, many of the financial metrics we forecast depend on two separate events: when guests book, and when they actually travel. A booking made today might correspond to a trip three days from now or three months from now. The distribution of that gap, what we call the lead-time composition, drives how we translate today's bookings into future revenue (see Figure 1).

The pandemic reshaped what was being booked and where. Hosts shifted their inventory toward longer stays and remote-friendly properties, while guests pivoted from urban centers to rural and suburban destinations. These supply and demand shifts interacted with each other over time, as hosts adapted listings to match evolving guest preferences and new inventory attracted new traveler segments.

Each of these dynamics introduces its own forecasting challenges, but they fall outside the scope of this article. Here, we focus on a more fundamental structural problem: the disruption of the lead time relationship between booking and travel.

Our models had learned stable patterns from years of data: seasonal rhythms, day-of-week effects, gradual trends. Then, as COVID took hold, lockdowns hit. A reopening would trigger a surge of demand, which would then reverse a week later. Rolling closures across different regions created patterns no historical data could have anticipated.

Figure 1. Heatmap of simulated booking counts for each (booking date, trip date) pair.

This is not a story unique to Airbnb. Every forecasting team at every company that deals with time-shifted metrics, such as insurance claims, subscription renewals, and supply chain orders, faced a version of the same problem. The specific challenge we want to highlight here is not just that the numbers changed. It's that the structure of the data changed, and our models were not designed to detect or adapt to structural shifts.

This post describes what we observed, the architectural decision it forced us into, and the second surprise we discovered once the dust settled.

The architectural insight: separate the what from the when

Before COVID, we forecasted trip-date metrics more or less directly. The models learned the relationship between bookings and eventual trips as an integrated process. This worked when the relationship was stable. During the pandemic, it stopped working because two things were moving at once: the volume of bookings, and the temporal distribution of when those bookings would be realized as trips. A third variable shifted as well: whether bookings would be realized at all. Cancellation rates spiked and became far less predictable, adding another layer of instability to the booking-to-trip relationship. That problem deserves its own treatment and is not the focus here, but it compounds everything that follows.

The lockdown-reopening-relockdown cycle was the forcing function. Different regions would go into lockdown, reopen at different times, then often, and unpredictably, go back into lockdown again.

Gross booking volumes were swinging wildly as restrictions changed, but so was the lead-time composition. When a region reopened, people would book trips for the subsequent week. When a new variant hit, last-minute bookings dried up, but far-out bookings for “someday, when this is over” persisted.

The two signals were tangled together, and models that tried to learn them jointly could not disentangle which changes were driven by surges in volume and which were structural shifts in booking behavior. This led us to a fundamental architectural decision: decompose the forecast into two separate components:

Gross metrics on the booking date axis. How many bookings (nights, fees) are we recording each day? This is a standard univariate (or multivariate) time series problem.

Lead-time composition. Of the bookings recorded today, what fraction correspond to trips happening in each future time window? This is a compositional time series, a vector of proportions which must sum to one. The final trip-date forecast is the product of the two: gross bookings, multiplied by the lead-time composition vector, so the booking-date axis generates the trip-date axis.

This decomposition might sound obvious in hindsight, but it required a modeling framework that could handle compositional data natively. Standard time series methods do not respect the simplex constraint: that is, proportions must be non-negative and sum to one. Naive approaches such as forecasting each lead-time bucket independently produce incoherent results: the shares do not add up, and individual components can go negative.

We developed a family of models called B-DARMA (Bayesian Dirichlet Auto-Regressive Moving Average) specifically for this class of problem. The name unpacks the approach: the Dirichlet distribution enforces valid compositions, the auto-regressive and moving average

Detroit moves toward opposing prediction markets in Coinbase federal lawsuit

Jacob Woodward · ReadWrite

A federal judge has approved a procedural agreement in the ongoing dispute between Coinbase and Michigan regulators. This clears the way for Detroit to become the first U. S. city to formally challenge sports-related prediction markets in court.

In a March 26 order, Shalina D. Kumar of the United States District Court for the Eastern District of Michigan signed off on a stipulation jointly submitted by Coinbase Financial Markets Inc. and state officials. The agreement resolves a dispute over recent filings tied to Coinbase's request for a preliminary injunction and sets a revised schedule for additional briefs.

Detroit looks to file an amicus curiae brief

Potentially the biggest development in the latest order is Detroit's planned involvement in the case. City officials approached both parties seeking permission to file an amicus curiae brief, a filing that allows a non-party to offer the court additional context, expertise, or legal arguments.

Both sides agreed to the request, and the court's order allows Detroit to submit its brief by April 3.

If the city ultimately argues against prediction markets, it would be the first time a U. S. municipality has taken a direct legal stance opposing the products. That could provide courts and regulators with a new perspective, particularly on how emerging wagering-style platforms affect communities at the local level.

The City of Detroit is poised to become the first municipality to come out against prediction markets. The Motor City has been granted permission by a federal judge to file an amicus curiae brief in support of Michigan's opposition to Coinbase's motion for preliminary injunction. pic.twitter.com/6tMW3YcaBU

— Daniel Wallach (@WALLACHLEGAL) March 27, 2026

Coinbase challenges state enforcement

The underlying lawsuit pits Coinbase against Dana Nessel and members of the Michigan Gaming Control Board, who are being sued in their official capacities.

Coinbase is seeking a preliminary injunction, which is a temporary court order that, if granted, would prevent Michigan from taking enforcement action while the judge considers the broader legal questions in the case. Such injunctions are typically sought when a company argues that immediate regulatory action could cause irreparable harm before the courts have fully resolved the dispute.

Filing dispute leads to revised briefing schedule

The procedural disagreement that prompted the latest order began in February, when Coinbase filed additional materials with the court, including a notice of supplemental authority and a motion requesting permission to respond to a proposed sur-reply from the defendants. The company also attached a lengthy exhibit outlining its planned response.

State officials objected to those filings on March 2, arguing they were improper. After further discussions, however, the parties reached a compromise: the state withdrew its objection and instead agreed to submit a formal response addressing the materials.

Under the court-approved stipulation, that response was due March 27. Judge Kumar's order formally adopts the agreed terms, putting the revised briefing schedule into effect.

Prediction markets face growing legal scrutiny

The dispute is unfolding against a backdrop of increasing national scrutiny of prediction markets, particularly contracts tied to sports outcomes. In Washington, D. C., bipartisan lawmakers have introduced legislation that would ban sports-related prediction markets, citing concerns that the products function too similarly to unregulated sports betting.

Courts across the country have also begun to issue diverging rulings. Examples of this include a judge in Nevada recently blocking certain event contracts offered by Kalshi, while a federal judge in Arizona declined to grant emergency relief that would have protected similar contracts from potential criminal enforcement.

Together, those decisions have contributed to a patchwork of legal outcomes that leaves the status of prediction markets unsettled across jurisdictions.

Municipal perspective could influence broader debate

Detroit's anticipated filing could carry weight beyond the immediate dispute between Coinbase and Michigan regulators. Cities are often the first to deal with the social and economic consequences of gambling activity, from problem gambling services to local enforcement concerns.

Detroit could help the court assess the potential community-level impacts of prediction markets as it decides whether Coinbase should receive the temporary protections it is seeking, and, more broadly, how these emerging financial products should be treated under existing gambling and commodities laws.

The post Detroit moves toward opposing prediction markets in Coinbase federal lawsuit appeared first on ReadWrite .

America's gambling machine runs on tech even as router ban looms

Suswati Basu · ReadWrite

A federal move announced Monday (March 23) targets new consumer-grade routers produced in foreign countries entering the US market, not the devices already in homes. The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) added those routers to its Covered List, which blocks new models from receiving the equipment authorization required for import and sale. The agency says the change does not affect routers consumers already own or models that were previously approved, meaning existing devices can remain in use.

This update to the Covered List does not prohibit the import, sale, or use of any existing device models the FCC previously authorized.

This follows a national security determination that such routers “pose unacceptable risks to the national security of the United States or the safety and security of United States persons.”

The change comes as gambling in the US has grown to an enormous scale. Legal gaming now functions almost like essential infrastructure, spread across nearly every state.

The US gambling market is measured in tens of billions

Start with the money. Commercial gaming alone brought in \$78.7 billion in 2025, a record according to the American Gaming Association. Tribal gaming added another \$43.9 billion in its 2025 fiscal year. The figures come from different reporting calendars, so they are not meant to be stacked as a precise combined total. Together, the figures point to a system generating well over \$100 billion a year. This doesn't even take into account the full ecosystem, such as state lotteries and other forms of gaming.

Record year for tribal gaming: \$43.9B in revenue and growth across all regions, according to the latest FY25 report from the @NIGCGov. @RWW pic.twitter.com/Dx0q9rzDy9

— Suswati Basu (@suswatibasu) March 3, 2026

The revenue sits on top of a sprawling physical network. By the end of 2024, there were 492 commercial casinos spread across 27 states. Tribal operations added 500-plus more sites across 29 states, depending on how properties are counted. Round it out, and the country supports roughly 1,000 land-based gambling locations before factoring in sportsbooks inside arenas, racetracks, lottery retailers, and online-only platforms.

The workforce is just as substantial. Federal labor data shows about 252,900 people employed in casino hotels and another 128,700 in other gambling-related industries. Together, that puts the sector at roughly 381,600 payroll jobs across those categories. A narrower occupational slice still counts more than 150,000 gambling services workers, including tens of thousands of dealers and supervisors.

Even in a digital era, the system depends heavily on human operators.

2025 was the sixth straight year of record growth. 2025 commercial gaming revenue rose 9.2% to \$78.72B, marking another all-time high for our industry.

Read the full report <https://t.co/x6Ays0jCkC>
pic.twitter.com/7d7jU8Zfv9

— American Gaming Association (@AmericanGaming) March 2, 2026

The online side has also surged into national-scale territory. Americans wagered \$166.94 billion on sports in 2025, producing \$16.96 billion in revenue. Early 2026 figures from the American Gaming Association show the pace continuing, with \$14.81 billion in handle in January alone and more than \$1.6 billion in monthly sportsbook revenue. With another \$1 billion from iGaming that month, it starts to resemble a constant financial system rather than a seasonal business.

Machines, endpoints, and surveillance everywhere

All of that activity requires a dense layer of hardware. There are likely between 600,000 and 1,000,000 electronic gaming devices in the country. The figure isn't official, but it's based on revenue data and typical slot machine performance. Slots alone generated billions per month at the start of 2026, which implies hundreds of thousands of active machines nationwide.

But slot cabinets are only the beginning. Modern casinos run on a mesh of systems: sportsbook kiosks, cashier terminals, loyalty card readers, player-tracking systems, hotel management terminals, and redemption machines. Behind the scenes, there are compliance servers, storage arrays, and networking gear tying everything together.

Today, the FCC took additional action to safeguard Americans and the communications networks we rely on.

The FCC added consumer routers produced in foreign countries to the agency's Covered List.

This action follows a national security determination provided by Executive Branch... pic.twitter.com/s3OoEo5NOV

— Brendan Carr (@BrendanCarrFCC) March 23, 2026

Taken together, that likely adds up to a few million connected or monitored devices. In total, somewhere between one and three million devices are tied to regulated gambling operations. The figure reflects the size of the property base and the density of technology inside each location rather than a single published dataset.

Then there is surveillance, one of the least visible but most critical components. Casinos are among the most camera-heavy environments in the country, driven by fraud prevention, dispute resolution, cash handling, and regulatory

Official PlayStation Podcast Episode 537: Speaking Saros

O'Dell Harmon Jr. (he/him) · PlayStation Blog

Email us at PSPodcast@sony.com !

Subscribe via Apple Podcasts, Spotify, or download here

Hey, everybody! Sid, Brett, Kristen, and I are back this week to talk about our latest platinum trophy runs, hands-on with Saros, and more. This week also features an interview with two Housemarque devs working on Saros — Creative Director Gregory Loudon and Art Director Simone Silvestri.

Next week's release highlights:

South of Midnight | PS5

Legacy of Kain: Ascendance | PS5

Darwin's Paradox | PS5

Fishbowl | PS5

MotionRec | PS5

Damon and Baby is now available — discover what sets this twin-stick shooter apart in our hands-on report. You can also experience its unique blend of comedy and action yourself, since it's out now.

Virtual Hunter VR launches on PS VR2 on May 27 — explore a vast open world sim, hunt diverse prey, experience dynamic weather, and decorate your lodge.

Directive 8020 PS5 Pro Features — Supermassive devs detail PS5 Pro's ray tracing, PSSR, and performance features for a haunting sci-fi narrative when the game launches on May 12.

Super Meat Boy 3D launches on PS5 on March 31 — See how the tough-as-nails side-scrolling series transitions into 3D, introducing new abilities like wall running and more.

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O'Dell Harmon Jr. – Content Communications Specialist, SIE

Thanks to Dormilón for our rad theme song and show music.

(For Southeast Asia) New Price Changes for PS5, PS5 Pro, and PlayStation Portal remote player

Isabelle Tomatis · PlayStation Blog

With continued pressures in the global economic landscape, we've made the decision to increase the prices of PS5, PS5 Pro, and PlayStation Portal remote player globally. We know that price changes impact our community, and after careful evaluation, we found this was a necessary step to ensure we can continue delivering innovative, high-quality gaming experiences to players worldwide.

The updated recommended retail prices for PS5 consoles are effective starting April 2, 2026 in the following markets.

U. S.

PS5 – \$649.99

PS5 Digital Edition – \$599.99

PS5 Pro – \$899.99

U. K.

PS5 – £569.99

PS5 Digital Edition – £519.99

PS5 Pro – £789.99

PS5 – €649.99

PS5 Digital Edition – €599.99

PS5 Pro – €899.99

PS5 – ¥97,980

PS5 Digital Edition – ¥89,980

PS5 Pro – ¥137,980

The updated recommended retail price for PlayStation Portal remote player is effective starting April 2 in the following markets.

U. S. – \$249.99

U. K. – £219.99

Europe – €249.99

Japan – ¥39,980

Directive 8020 PS5 Pro Features — Supermassive devs detail PS5 Pro's ray tracing, PSSR, and performance features for a haunting sci-fi narrative when the game launches on May 12.

O'Dell Harmon Jr. (he/him)

World's Smallest QR Code - Smaller Than Bacteria - Could Store Data for Centuries

EditorDavid · Slashdot

“Scientists have created a microscopic QR code so tiny it can only be seen with an electron microscope,” reports Science Daily. It’s “smaller than most bacteria and now officially a world record.”

“But this isn’t just about size; it’s about durability. By engraving data into ultra-stable ceramic materials, the team has opened the door to storing information that could last for centuries or even millennia without needing power or maintenance.”

Scientists at TU Wien, working with data storage company Cerabyte, produced a QR code measuring just 1.98 square micrometers... officially confirmed and recorded in the Guinness Book of Records...

Each pixel measures just 49 nanometers, which is about ten times smaller than the wavelength of visible light. As a result, the pattern is completely invisible under normal conditions and cannot be resolved using visible light. However, when viewed with an electron microscope, the QR code can be clearly and reliably read. The storage capacity is also impressive. More than 2 terabytes of data could fit within the area of a single A4 sheet of paper using this approach...

This work points toward a more sustainable future for data storage, where information can be preserved securely for the long term with minimal energy use. “We live in the information age, yet we store our knowl-

edge in media that are astonishingly short-lived,” says Alexander Kirnbaue (from the thin film materials science division at Vienna’s Tu Wein research university). “With ceramic storage media, we are pursuing a similar approach to that of ancient cultures, whose inscriptions we can still read today...”

“We now aim to use other materials, increase writing speeds, and develop scalable manufacturing processes so that ceramic data storage can be used not only in laboratories but also in industrial applications.”

Read more of this story at Slashdot.

It Takes A Village

Penny Arcade

We warned of spoilers in the Project Hail Mary trailer, but having read the book now - and living in a world where The Martian exists as a book and a film - I understand why they needed to show everything in that trailer. You can’t have a situation where people call the movie “The Martian On A Spaceship.” Now that I know everything in the book - I’m literate!!! -I would say that they have not, in fact, spoiled the main thing. I can’t wait to go see this shit - there’s just so much interesting work that had to be done before they could even tell the story.

Jupiter's Lightning May Have the Force of Nuclear Weapons

EditorDavid · Slashdot

How powerful is Jupiter's lightning? Thick clouds cover the view, notes Science magazine. But using an instrument on NASA's Juno spacecraft (orbiting Jupiter for the past decade), researchers determined Jupiter's lightning bolts are 100 to 10,000 times more energetic than earth's:

A single bolt of lightning on Earth releases about 1 billion joules of energy. That means the most extreme bolts of jovian lightning carry 10 trillion joules of energy, equivalent to 2400 tons of TNT, or one-sixth the power of the atomic bomb dropped on Hiroshima, Japan. Based on the rates of flashes seen by Juno, storms on this tempestuous world can unleash the force of multiple nuclear weapons every minute...

The four storms Juno studied were monstrous, says Michael Wong, a planetary scientist at the University of California, Berkeley and one of the study's authors. There were three flashes per second on average, often emerging from the hearts of storms that are 3000 kilometers across, longer than the distance from New York City to Denver. The researchers used the Hubble Space Telescope (and photographs from Juno's camera) to track Jupiter's storms with such precision that their radiometer could then pick out individual lightning flashes, according to the article.

"It's just a massive ball of gas. It makes sense that there's very energetic lightning happening," says Daniel Mitchard, a lightning physicist at Cardiff University who wasn't involved with the new study. But confirming such suspicions "is exciting," he says, because lightning plays an important role in forging complex chemistry — including the sort that primordial life is built on.

Thanks to Slashdot reader sciencehabit for sharing the article.

Read more of this story at Slashdot.

BRIEFS

Runner's World, Runner's World: This planner offers goal-setting advice, as well as pages for tracking workouts, shoes, and all the books on your nightstand.

Jeremy Smith, /Film: Denzel Washington's time travel sci-fi movie *Déjà Vu* was overshadowed by *Casino Royale* when it first released, but it's well worth revisiting.

Bruno Couriol, InfoQ: Max Inden recently explored in a talk at FOSDEM 2026 how the upcoming WebTransport protocol and Web API enhance WebSocket capabilities. WebTransport seeks to provide, among other things, lower latency and transparent network switching for key use cases such as high-frequency financial data streaming, cloud gaming, live streaming, and collaborative editing.

By Bruno Couriol

Andy Swift, TVLine: Who's going to prison? And can we trust Mallory and Kimmie's alliance? Taylor Polidore Williams takes TVLine inside the finale of *Beauty in Black* Season 2.

Devin Meenan, /Film: Two of the darkest episodes of *Battlestar Galactica* were clearly influenced by another sci-fi story's all timer of an ending.

Kyle Barr, Gizmodo: It's the cheapest way to access Intel's exciting new CPUs. You'll just have to deal with a few pain points.

Penny Arcade, Penny Arcade: There's no way to contextualize how ready Gabriel was to pawn something. That was just his bank, kinda. Anytime E3 rolled around he started foraging for anything made of silver colored plastic. He would have sold me if he could! I would have sold me too, I guess. Rented, at least. But panel three of this strip is a documentary.

Andy Swift, TVLine: Tyler Perry previously filmed the entire second season of Netflix's *Beauty in Black* in just 12 days. He beat his record with Season 3.

Zack Zwiezen, Kotaku: The posts were part of his administration celebrating plans to bail farmers out of a situation created by Trump's own actions

Penny Arcade, Penny Arcade: If you like what you see, you can play it pretty much anywhere . Next Friday I'm gonna teach Dabe how to play on some sponsored stuff - now he's wrapping up all the video walls for PAX East , so he's gonna have to watch the stream if he's gonna bone up. Join me right here if you want to see what I am typically doing between midnight and one in the morning.

(CW)TB

Jupiter Hadley, Indie Games Plus: A Week in the Life of Asocial Giraffe is a point and click puzzle adventure game about a tall-necked giraffe that wants to stay unseen. I got the chance to play a...

The post 'Asocial Giraffe' Needs You to Avoid Being Noticed appeared first on Indie Games Plus .

Ben Thompson, Stratechery: Arm is selling its own chips, not just licensing IP. It's a big change compared to Arm's history, but not surprising given how computing is evolving.

Sam Stone, /Film: A great miniseries knows how to tell an engaging story on television but also knows when to wrap it up rather than overstay its welcome, and these are the best.

Nick Caruso, TVLine: On TV this Sunday: Kayce tracks down a missing girl on Marshals, Chee confronts his past on *Dark Winds*, and *Crossroad Springs* wraps its freshman run.

Ben Thompson, Stratechery: GTC 2026 marked an important inflection point for Nvidia, as the company is selling multiple architectures, instead of focusing on just one GPU. The motivation is serve all needs and keep all customers.

Renato Losio, InfoQ: ProxySQL 3.0.6 was recently released, along with a new multi-tier release strategy. The Stable Tier focuses on reliability and production use, the Innovative Tier introduces newer features earlier, and the AI/MCP Tier explores future capabilities, including AI integrations.

By Renato Losio

Jupiter Hadley, Indie Games Plus: Broken Race is a roguelike racing game where you watch the world glitch, change, and distort as your sanity falls apart. Often racing games have you racing against other people, trying to...

The post 'Broken Race' Continually Changes the Rules of the Road appeared first on Indie Games Plus .

Leela Kumili, InfoQ: Agoda engineers developed Storefront, a Rust-based S3-compatible reverse proxy that improves load balancing, request routing, and observability across large-scale object storage systems. The proxy addresses DNS-based distribution limitations, implements latency-aware routing, cross-data-center optimizations, IO safeguards, credential-less authentication, and exposes telemetry via OpenTelemetry.

By Leela Kumili

Jupiter Hadley, Indie Games Plus: Dark Tides is an adventure game where you play as a boardwalk psychic unravelling the demonic mysteries of a seaside Victorian town. Playing as Theodora Green, you are tasked with figuring out...

The post 'Dark Tides' Reads Minds to Discover an Old Town's True Fate appeared first on Indie Games Plus .

Jupiter Hadley, Indie Games Plus: Ghost Haunting is an adventure game about a young girl whose grandmother has been trapped in the realm of the dead. You are a young 8-year old child currently visiting your grandfather...

The post 'Ghost Haunting' Follows Unruly Children Attempting Resurrections appeared first on Indie Games Plus .
The 2026 State of AI in Enterprise Infrastructure Security, a report published by infrastructure identity company, Teleport. The study found that identity management hasn't kept up with AI adoption in production systems.

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